

W

68 | WHEN INTERGLOBE ENTERPRISES launched MOVIN Express—a B2B logistics JV with UPS—last May, J.B. Singh, Director of the company, did not expect it to be such a success. Singh, a veteran of the aviation and hospitality industries, attributes it to a mind shift happening across the world's fifth-largest economy, where clients prefer to deal with structured, high-performance logistics players. "They want a process-driven environment, things to move on schedule, and high-performance teams to bring down costs and make things more efficient," says Singh, during an interaction with *BT* in his sun-kissed office in Gurugram. MOVIN has expanded to 49 cities in Q3FY23 from 28 in Q2, nearly doubled its headcount to 800 personnel from 460, and currently reaches more than 3,000 pin codes in India.

In eastern India, regional carrier IndiaOne Air launched operations last August with two nine-seater Cessna Grand Caravan EX aircraft to underserved destinations such as the left-wing extremism-impacted

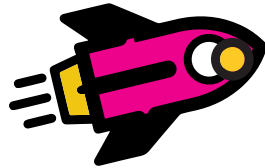
Jeypore district in Odisha. The airline today covers eight destinations, and has consistently reported passenger load factors (occupied seats in aircraft) of over 90 per cent since inception, data from Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) shows. "If urbanisation in India has to rise to 50 per cent, and its GDP has to jump to \$15-20 trillion over the next two decades, aviation has to become accessible to the people living in Tier II and III cities," says Arun K. Singh, CEO of IndiaOne Air.

Down South, Chennai-based Sri-

nath Ravichandran, with a Master's in Aerospace Engineering from the University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign, returned to India in 2017, intending to take spacetechnology to the masses. Bonding with Moin S.P.M. over games of backyard cricket, he co-founded AgniKul in 2017. In November 2021, AgniKul became not only the first spacetechnology player to successfully test a single-piece 3D-printed rocket engine, but also became the first Indian company to open a spaceport and mission control centre at the iconic Satish Dhawan Space Centre

A SNAPSHOT OF INDIAN START-UPS

India has emerged as the world's third-largest start-up ecosystem



89,000+

START-UPS
RECOGNISED
BY DPIIT

5,000+

FUNDED
START-UPS

108

UNICORNS

\$400

BILLION-PLUS
COMBINED
VALUATION

BHARATMALA PARIYOJANA

THE PROJECT ENVISAGES THE DEVELOPMENT OF 26,000-KM LENGTH OF ECONOMIC CORRIDORS

CHENAB RAILWAY BRIDGE

THE WORLD'S HIGHEST RAILWAY BRIDGE WILL CONNECT KASHMIR VALLEY WITH THE REST OF INDIA

DELHI-MUMBAI EXPRESSWAY

EXPECTED TO BE COMPLETED IN Q1CY23, THE 1,350-KM ROAD WILL CUT DOWN TRAVEL TIME BETWEEN MUMBAI AND DELHI FROM 30 TO 12 HOURS

GAGANYAAN

INDIA'S FIRST HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT PROJECT WILL LAUNCH A THREE-MEMBER CREW INTO A 400-KM ORBIT ON A THREE-DAY MISSION

INLAND WATERWAYS DEVELOPMENT

DEVELOPMENT OF 111 NATIONAL WATERWAYS FOR SMOOTHER AS WELL AS COST-EFFECTIVE MOVEMENT OF CARGO USING RIVERBOATS